ARFÜD Mobile App - Project Scope & Milestones

Project Overview

ARFÜD is a mobile application designed to help individuals with ARFID manage safe foods, reduce decision fatigue, and simplify grocery shopping. This document outlines the scope and timeline for MVP development.

PROJECT SCOPE

In Scope (What WILL Be Built):

Core Features:

- User authentication (signup, login, password reset)
- Safe foods database with CRUD operations
- Sensory attribute tagging system (texture, temperature, taste, etc.)
- Filter and sort functionality for safe foods
- Stock tracking (in-stock/out-of-stock status)
- Grocery list with manual item addition
- Auto-populate grocery list from out-of-stock items
- Ingredient selection workflow
- Category organization for grocery items
- Basic reminder system (eating reminders, shopping reminders)
- Push notifications
- "All foods" archive for previously safe foods

Technical Requirements:

- iOS mobile application
- Backend API for data management
- Database for user profiles, safe foods, grocery lists, and reminders
- Secure user authentication and data storage
- Cloud-based data persistence across devices

Deliverables:

- Functional iOS mobile application
- Backend server and API
- Database schema and implementation
- Basic admin/debugging tools
- Documentation for code and API endpoints
- User testing feedback incorporated

Out of Scope (What Will NOT Be Built in MVP):

Features Deferred to Future Phases:

- AI chatbot for meal decisions
- AI recipe generation
- AI-powered grocery receipt scanning
- Food journal with mood tracking
- Nutrition tracking and analytics
- Community features (social sharing, forums)
- Advanced grocery features (price tracking, store mapping, list sharing)
- Caregiver/family account linking
- Multiple grocery lists
- Recipe storage
- Meal planning calendar
- Android version

Technical Elements Deferred:

- Third-party API integrations (nutrition databases, AI services)
- Advanced analytics dashboard
- Export/backup functionality beyond basic data persistence
- Integration with other health apps
- Web version

PROJECT MILESTONES & TIMELINE

Project Duration: Spring 2026 - Spring 2027 (3 semesters)

SEMESTER 1: Spring 2026 (Planning & Foundation)

Milestone 1: Project Kickoff & Technical Planning *(Weeks 1-3)*

- Finalize technical stack decision (Swift/SwiftUI vs. React Native, backend framework, database)
- Review and refine wireframes with development team
- Set up development environment and repositories
- Define coding standards and workflow
- Create detailed technical specifications

Deliverables:

- Technical architecture document
- Development environment setup
- GitHub repository with initial structure
- Project management board (Jira, Trello, etc.)

Milestone 2: Database & Authentication *(Weeks 4-7)*

- Design and implement database schema
- Build user authentication system
- Create basic API endpoints for user management
- Set up cloud hosting/backend infrastructure

Deliverables:

- Functional database with all required tables
- Working signup/login system
- Password reset functionality
- API documentation for auth endpoints

Milestone 3: Safe Foods Core Functionality *(Weeks 8-12)*

- Implement safe foods CRUD operations
- Build sensory tagging system
- Create safe foods list view with basic UI

- Implement add/edit food forms
- Build stock tracking functionality

Deliverables:

- Users can add, view, edit, and delete safe foods
- Sensory attributes can be assigned and displayed
- Stock status can be toggled
- Data persists across sessions

Milestone 4: Filtering & Organization *(Weeks 13-15)*

- Implement filter functionality (by sensory attributes, category, stock status)
- Build sorting options (alphabetical, date added, category)
- Create "All Foods" archive view
- Refine UI/UX based on team feedback

Deliverables:

- Functional filter system with multiple criteria
- Multiple sort options
- Archive system for removed safe foods
- **End of Semester 1: Core safe foods management complete**

SEMESTER 2: Fall 2026 (Grocery, Reminders & Launch)

Milestone 5: Grocery List Foundation *(Weeks 1-4)*

- Build grocery list data structure
- Implement manual item addition
- Create grocery list UI with category organization
- Add check-off functionality
- Build item deletion/management

Deliverables:

- Functional grocery list separate from safe foods
- Items organized by category
- Check-off and removal capabilities

Milestone 6: Integrated Workflows *(Weeks 5-7)*

- Implement "mark out of stock" workflow
- Build ingredient selection dialog
- Create auto-populate grocery list functionality
- Connect safe foods to grocery list system
- Handle edge cases (single vs. multi-ingredient foods)

Deliverables:

- Seamless flow from marking food out-of-stock to adding ingredients to grocery list
- Ingredient selection interface
- Logic for automatic grocery list population

Milestone 7: Reminders & Notifications *(Weeks 8-10)*

- Implement push notification system
- Build reminder creation and management UI
- Create eating reminders
- Create shopping reminders
- Add reminder customization options (time, frequency)

Deliverables:

- Working push notifications on iOS
- Users can create, edit, and delete reminders
- Notifications trigger at set times

Milestone 8: UI Polish & Bug Fixes *(Weeks 11-12)*

- Refine all UI screens for consistency
- Fix identified bugs
- Improve loading states and error handling
- Add empty states for new users
- Optimize performance

Deliverables:

- Polished, consistent UI across all screens
- Resolved bug list
- Smooth user experience
- **Feature-complete MVP ready for testing**

Milestone 9: Alpha Testing *(Weeks 13-14)*

- Internal team testing
- Fix critical bugs
- Gather feedback from founder and initial testers
- Make necessary adjustments
- Prepare for beta launch

Deliverables:

- Stable alpha build
- Bug fixes implemented
- Test feedback documented

Milestone 10: Beta Launch *(Week 15 + Winter Break)*

- Deploy to limited beta testers (20-50 users from waitlist)
- Monitor app performance and crashes
- Gather user feedback over winter break
- Begin documenting issues for Spring semester fixes

Deliverables:

- Beta version deployed to TestFlight
- User feedback collection process established
- Initial user response documented
- **End of Semester 2: Beta testing in progress**

SEMESTER 3: Spring 2027 (Testing Refinement & Launch)

Milestone 11: Beta Refinement *(Weeks 1-5)*

- Analyze winter break beta feedback

- Fix bugs identified in real-world use
- Iterate on UX issues
- Implement critical user requests if feasible
- Continue beta testing with refined build

Deliverables:

- Updated beta build with bug fixes
- User feedback analyzed and prioritized
- Critical issues resolved
- Improved user experience based on feedback

Milestone 12: Public Launch Preparation *(Weeks 6-10)*

- Final bug fixes and optimizations
- Prepare app store listings (descriptions, screenshots, keywords)
- Create user onboarding flow
- Set up analytics and monitoring
- Prepare marketing materials
- Submit to Apple App Store

Deliverables:

- App store submission completed
- Marketing materials ready
- Analytics tracking implemented
- Onboarding flow finalized

Milestone 13: Launch & Handoff *(Weeks 11-15)*

- Monitor app store review process
- Public app launch
- Monitor initial user response
- Address any launch issues
- Complete project documentation
- Handoff to founder for ongoing maintenance

Deliverables:

- Live app on iOS App Store
- Complete technical documentation
- Handoff meeting with founder
- Post-launch support plan established
- **Final deliverable: Functional, launched ARFÜD MVP**

SUCCESS CRITERIA

The project will be considered successful when:

- Users can create accounts and securely store data
- Users can manage safe foods with sensory attributes and filtering
- Users can track stock status and generate grocery lists automatically
- Users receive timely reminders for eating and shopping
- App is stable, performant, and user-friendly
- App is published on iOS App Store
- At least 50 beta users have tested and provided feedback
- Critical bugs are resolved and app is ready for public use

RISKS & MITIGATION

Risk	Mitigation Strategy
Timeline slips due to technical complexity	Build in 2-week buffer periods; prioritize core features first; three-semester timeline provides cushion
Team member availability changes	Document code thoroughly; use version control; have backup team members
App store approval delays	Submit early with buffer time in Spring 2027; follow all guidelines carefully
Technical limitations of chosen framework	Research framework capabilities upfront; have backup plan
User feedback requires major changes	Plan iterative releases; MVP focuses on core value first; beta testing in Fall 2026 allows time to address issues

Data security concerns	Implement industry-standard security practices from day one
Beta testing reveals major issues	Three-semester timeline allows full semester for refinement after beta feedback

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POST-MVP ROADMAP (Phase 2)

After successful MVP launch, future development phases will include:

- Android version
- AI chatbot for meal decision support
- AI recipe generation from safe foods
- AI-powered grocery receipt scanning
- Food journal with mood tracking
- Nutrition tracking and insights
- Community features
- Premium subscription tier

These features represent the long-term value proposition and revenue model but are intentionally excluded from MVP scope to ensure timely, quality delivery of core functionality.

RESOURCES & SUPPORT

From Founder (Rigby):

- All design files and wireframes in Figma
- Branding guidelines
- Business and marketing plans
- User research and market validation
- Ongoing availability for questions and feedback
- Beta tester recruitment from waitlist
- $1,000 prize money for development expenses

From Development Team:

- Full-stack development expertise

- iOS mobile app development
- Backend/API development
- Database design and implementation
- Testing and QA

From Faculty:

- Technical guidance and mentorship
- Project management oversight
- Code reviews and best practices
- Academic credit for capstone work

CONTACT & COMMUNICATION

Project Sponsor: [Your Name]
Email: [Your Email]
Phone: [Your Phone]

Preferred Communication:

- Weekly check-in meetings (in-person or Zoom)
- Slack/Discord channel for quick questions
- GitHub for code reviews and technical discussion
- Shared project board for milestone tracking

Document Version: 1.2
Last Updated: [Today's Date]
Next Review: After project team assignment

Absolutely! Here's the updated version with Android added back in:

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- Ingredient selection workflow
- Category organization for grocery items
- Basic reminder system (eating reminders, shopping reminders)
- Push notifications
- "All foods" archive for previously safe foods

Technical Requirements:

- Cross-platform mobile app (iOS and Android)
- Backend API for data management
- Database for user profiles, safe foods, grocery lists, and reminders
- Secure user authentication and data storage
- Cloud-based data persistence across devices

Deliverables:

- Functional mobile application (testable on both iOS and Android)
- Backend server and API
- Database schema and implementation
- Basic admin/debugging tools

- Documentation for code and API endpoints
- User testing feedback incorporated

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User feedback requires major changes	Plan iterative releases; MVP focuses on core value first; beta testing in Fall 2026 allows time to address issues
Data security concerns	Implement industry-standard security practices from day one
Beta testing reveals major issues	Three-semester timeline allows full semester for refinement after beta feedback
Platform-specific bugs or differences	Use cross-platform framework (React Native or Flutter) to minimize divergence; allocate time for platform-specific testing

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POST-MVP ROADMAP (Phase 2)

After successful MVP launch, future development phases will include:

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- Project management oversight
- Code reviews and best practices
- Academic credit for capstone work

CONTACT & COMMUNICATION

Project Sponsor: Rigby Wolff
Email: cwolff1867@gmail.com
Phone: 801-583-2331

Preferred Communication:

- Weekly check-in meetings (in-person or Zoom)
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